

THE ARMY MILITARY-CIVILIAN COST SYSTEM (AMCOS) PAY PLAN Xwalk Tutorial



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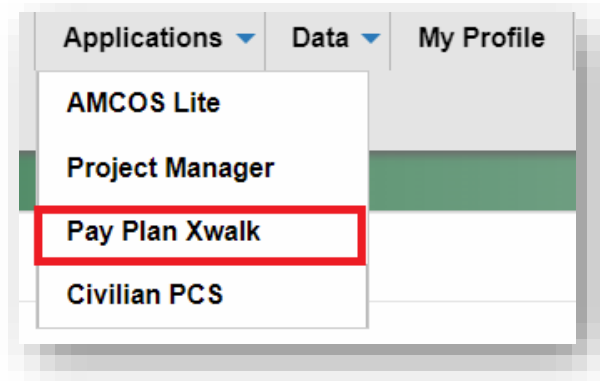
PURPOSE

The purpose of Pay Plan Xwalk is to facilitate the comparison of costs across Pay Plan types. AMCOS contains three pay plan types: Military (e.g., Active Enlisted - AE); Civilian (e.g. General Schedule - GS); and Contractor (Contractor Cost Estimate - CCE). As an example, the below tutorial uses a **0560 Budget Analyst GS-14 at the Pentagon** (Washington, D.C. area) and displays costs for similar Military and Contractor scenarios.

Note: For further information on the methodology of how the cross walk works please see the Pay Plan Cost Walk Methodology Document.

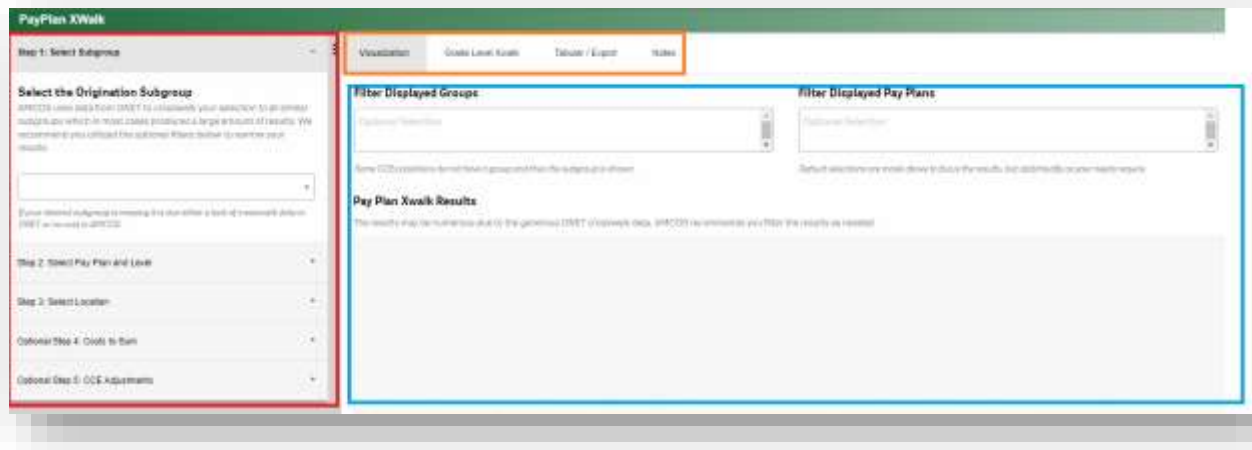
TUTORIAL

The Pay Plan Xwalk Tutorial provides text and screen images that help guide you through the application. The application is accessible through the 'Applications' drop down and the 'Pay Plan Xwalk' menu link (see below).



The App consists of 3 primary sections (see screen image on the next page):

- selections panel (red rectangle) – facilitates the selection of the position to start the comparison
- content panel (blue rectangle) – displays the data resulting from the selections panel
- tab menu (orange rectangle) – navigation to adjust what is displayed in the content panel



SELECTIONS PANEL

STEP 1: SELECT SUBGROUP

You may search for and select any subgroup (e.g. Military Occupation Specialty (MOS); Civilian Series; Standard Occupational Code (SOC); etc). This subgroup selection will form the basis for what then is allowed in the subsequent steps. For this tutorial we will use a **Budget Analyst (0560)** which is shown in the image to the right. Because the subgroup list is quite long, we recommend using the search feature either by the position number (if you know it) or a word search on the nomenclature.

For reference, the format for subgroup numbers is generally as follows:

AMCOS Subgroup types:

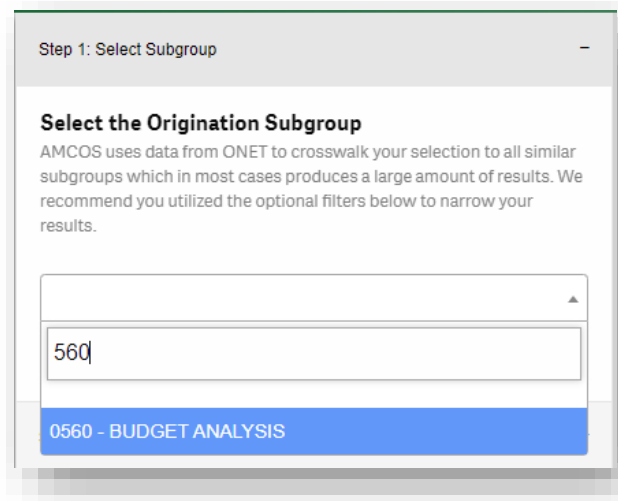
- Military Officer/Enlisted: ##α (e.g. 11B)
- Military Warrant Officer: ###α (e.g. 120A)
- Civilian: #####(α) (e.g. 0560)
- Contractor: ##-#### (e.g. 13-2031)

Legend:

= number

α = letter

(α) = optional 5th position, this is rare and only in cases with specific special pay circumstance (e.g. Firefighters)



STEP 2: PAY PLAN AND LEVEL

Now that the subgroup selection is made, we need to tell the application what our pay plan and level basis is. In AMCOS we have four types of levels:

- Grade Level (e.g. 0-19): Used for most Civilians and all Military positions
- Pay Band (e.g. 1-5) – used for only select pay plans that are pay banded (e.g. DB)
- Min (1); Average (2); Max (3) (e.g. SES)
- Percentile (e.g. 50th) – used for CCE

Because a Pay Band number is not equal to a Grade level (e.g. DB2 does not equate to GS2) the Pay Plan and Grade Level must be selected at the same time so your cross walk intentions are clear. If you do not see the desired pay plan, then return to Step 1 and select a subgroup that matches the pay plan type you desire.

In the example shown we've selected 0560 (A civilian subgroup type) so all pay plans and levels that have costs for a 0560 are available in the drop down. We select **13-GS**.

STEP 3: SELECT LOCATION

You may want to cost a location in and around a military installation making the Military Installation drop down the most helpful. However, if you want to cost a specific area that is not near a military installation, or you want to have complete control over what area(s) are being costed then use the 'Select Specific Location(s)' drop down.

Continuing with our example in the image to the right we have the Military Installation of the **Pentagon** selected. Immediately after the selection is made the Visualization content panel will populate (if desired you may jump to the discussion on the V panel). To demonstrate which specific locations this entails we also clicked into the Specific Location drop down revealing three areas:

- Washington Metropolitan Statistical Area (MSA) which is a CCE based location
- Washington Locality Area which is a civilian based location
- Washington Military Housing Area (MHA) which of course is a military based location

At this point you may either remove the Pentagon selection and select the three Washington locations or continue with the Pentagon selection. We will do the latter.

To reiterate, you need only make a single selection from the Military Installation drop down, or one or more selections from the Specific Location drop down.

If using the Specific Locations drop down note that in order to see all of the available results you will need to select a location for each available location type. For example: If we select the Military Installation of Pentagon then to obtain equivalency from the Specific Location drop down we need to select all available Washington DC area options. This is because CCE uses Metropolitan Statistical Areas (MSAs), most Civilian Plans use Locality Pay Areas (or Wage Areas), and Military uses Military Housing Areas (MHAs). Each have their own unique footprints so selecting them individually provides greater control over the results. Revisiting our example one last time, because no cross walk exists between a Budget Analyst GS-13 and a Wage position, no Wage Area option exists.

OPTIONAL STEP 4: COSTS TO SUM

By default the application will cost a fully burdened position (inclusive of all costs). However, if you only want to compare salary you may select 'Base Pay.' Generally, if you are comparing salary, AMCOS recommends you include any applicable Basic Allowance for Housing (BAH) and Cost of Living Allowance (COLA) for an apples to apples comparison. If you wish to compare only non-salary costs, then select 'Other Pay' (which as shown in the note will exclude CCE pay plans in the result set).

Optional Step 4: Costs to Sum

It is a best practice to either: compare all costs (no selection needed); compare base pay and locality based pay (Base Pay, BAH, COLA); or compare non base compensation (Other Pay)

BAH

Base Pay

COLA

Other Pay

Selecting only 'Other Pay' will exclude CCE.

OPTIONAL STEP 5: CCE ADJUSTMENTS

Contractor non-salary costs may vary widely based on factors which include the wrap rate of the company (cost structure), the bid fee/profit, and the bid hours. AMCOS provides default values but you may adjust these based on your circumstances. Please refer to the 'Notes' tab for more details and a full explanation on these adjustment factors.

Optional Step 5: CCE Adjustments

Adjust CCE Wrap 1.9 See the CCE Note tab for an explanation	Adjust CCE Fee/Profit 1 See the CCE Note tab for an explanation
Adjust CCE Annual Hours 2080 See the CCE Note tab for an explanation	Adjust CCE Bid Hours 1880 See the CCE Note tab for an explanation

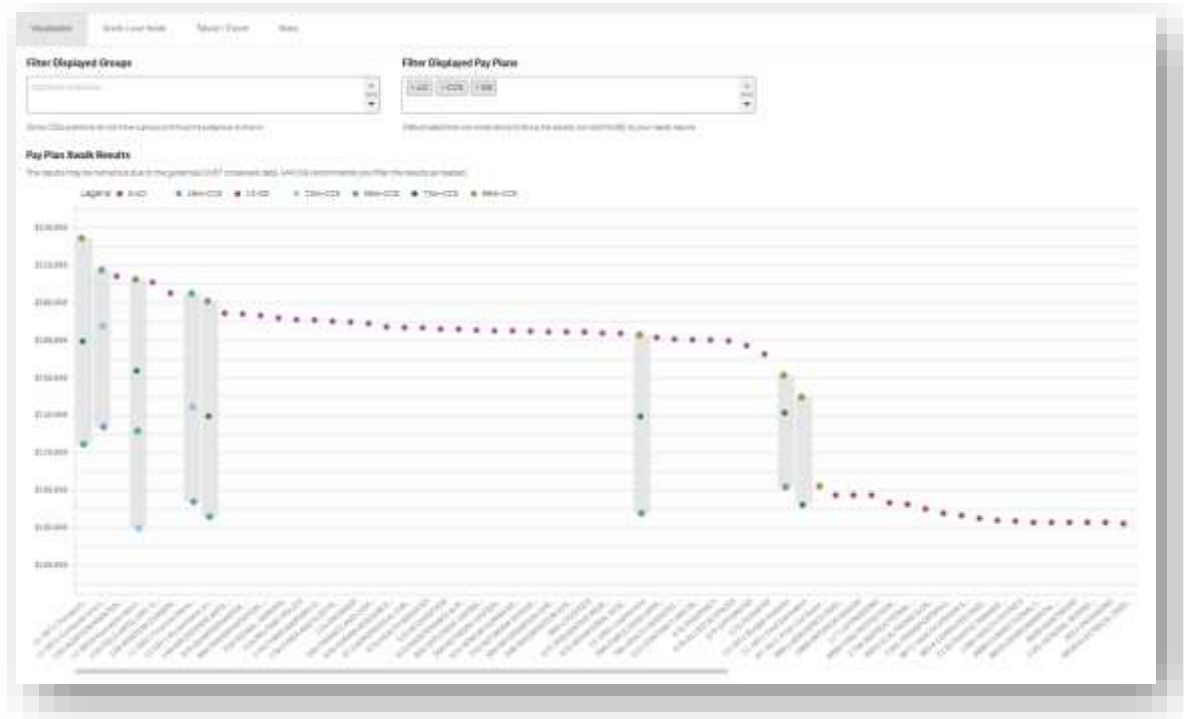
CONTENT PANEL

The content panel will display content that is applicable to the tab you've selected. It defaults to the Visualization Tab. Please see the Tab Menu section for a walkthrough of the panel for each tab.

TAB MENU

VISUALIZATION

This tab provides for visualization of the cost data based on selections made in steps 1-3 (to include optional steps 4 & 5). The image here displays the results from our example selection of **0560 Budget Analyst GS 13 for the Pentagon**.



An explanation of the chart elements follows:

- The X (horizontal) axis – lists the subgroup number and nomenclature for all similar positions based on the subgroup, pay plan, and level selection.
- The Y (vertical) axis – lists the monetary value based on the selection made in the Optional Step 4.
- Legend – displays the color coded dot associated with each Level and Pay Plan shown on the chart
- Filter Displayed Groups – provides an option to filter the results based on overarching groups of subgroups which is helpful if you'd like to compare only subgroups within the same group
- Filter Displayed Pay Plans
 - allows for the selection of specific pay plans to add to or reduce the displayed results

- It will also automatically filter your pay plan filters based on the following:
 - Select a Civilian subgroup -> Filter displays the origination pay plan + applicable Military Pay plans + CCE
 - Select a Contractor subgroup -> Filter displays the origination pay plan + applicable Military Pay plans + applicable Civilian Pay Plans
 - Select a Military subgroup -> Filter displays the origination pay plan + applicable Civilian Pay plans + CCE
 - You may adjust the Pay Plan filter further to suite your needs

Notes:

- *AMCOS' source data for the crosswalk comes from ONET (see the Pay Plan Xwalk Methodology for further details) and as such may return many results that need to be filtered based on your needs.*
- *Due to the size of the data this tab will not display data until Steps 1-3 are completed.*

In the displayed chart it becomes clear that certain military positions have a fully burdened cost estimate that vastly exceeds GS positions (usually due to military training costs). If you want to compare salary costs only, then Optional Step 4 will help with that. In the displayed image to the right, the selections of **Base Pay, BAH, and COLA** were made thus excluding all other costs.

Optional Step 4: Costs to Sum

It is a best practice to either: compare all costs (no selection needed); compare base pay and locality based pay (Base Pay, BAH, COLA); or compare non base compensation (Other Pay)

BAH

Base Pay

COLA

Other Pay

Selecting only 'Other Pay' will exclude CCE.

There are still a lot of results so before we revisit the chart we further filter things down via the Filter Displayed Groups option. Looking at the list of subgroups we can see there are some similar military positions in the **36 Finance and Comptroller** group, some similar contractor positions in the **13-2000 Financial Specialists** group and the **0500 Accounting and Budget** group for the civilian workforce. The selections added to the filter are shown in the image below.

Filter Displayed Groups

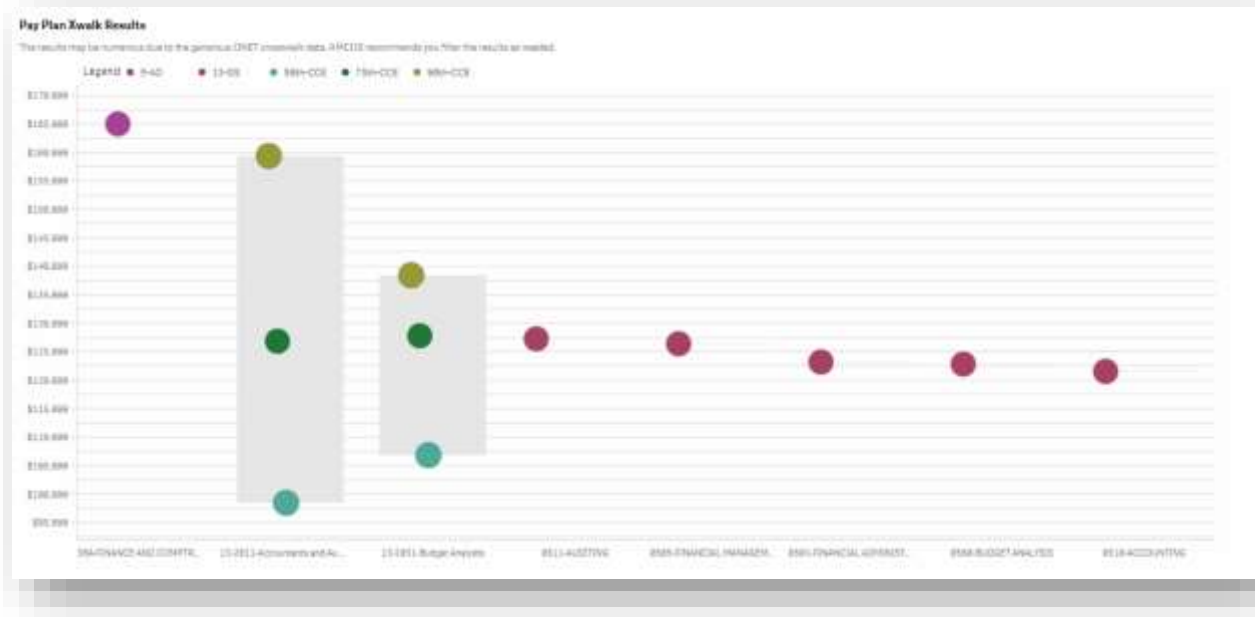
* 13-2000 - Financial Specialists

* 36 - FINANCE AND COMPTROLLER

* 0500 - ACCOUNTING AND BUDGET GROUP

Some CCEs positions do not have a group and thus the subgroup is shown.

The result of the changes above is shown in the image below. Comparatively speaking, an Active Officer O5 with BAH is paid more than contractor positions in the 50th, 75th, and 90th percentile for budget and accountant positions, and more than any 0500 type civilian position. At this point we conclude the analysis for this scenario but demonstrate the export capability in the Tabular/Export tab section.



GRADE LEVEL XWALK

Based on the selection in Step 2 (Pay Plan/Level) AMCOS will determine equivalent pay plans and levels to cross walk to. This Level association may be confusing at times so we provide the complete cross walk in this tab to assist with your understanding. If no selections are made, then the entire table is shown and can be downloaded. If you begin making selections, as we have in our earlier example, then this tab will display filtered results (see image below). Please see the Pay Plan Xwalk Methodology document for a complete explanation of how level cross walking is done.

Visualization Grade Level Xwalk Tabular / Export Notes					
PayPlan Grade Level/Pay Band Crosswalk					
AMCOS uses DoCS 1806-81, AR 678 Table S-6, the Appropriated Fund Operating Manual Subchapter 11, and assumed equivalency between WG/WL/WB and FA/NL/RB in order to connect grade levels/pay bands across Pay Plans.					
From PayPlan	To Grade/Level/Band	To PayPlan	To Grade/Level/Band		
GS	13	AO	E		
GS	13	CCE	58th		
GS	13	CCE	75th		
GS	13	CCE	98th		
GS	13	GS	13		

If you are interested in the raw data instead of the visualization then this tab will allow you to view and download the data in its entirety for the selections made. The image below shows the data for the scenario worked up to this point.

Verification	Grade Level Profile	Table / Export	Notes							
Pay Plan	Grade Code	Grade Description	Subgroup Code	Subgroup Description	Depen. Status	Grade Level	Location	Number of Decern.	Pay Type	ETV
AO	36	FINANCE AND COMPTROLLER	36A	FINANCE AND COMPTROLLER	-	3	WASHINGTON, DC METRO AREA	-1	Base Pay	Not
AO	36	FINANCE AND COMPTROLLER	36A	FINANCE AND COMPTROLLER	average	3	WASHINGTON, DC METRO AREA	-1	WAW	Not
AO	36	FINANCE AND COMPTROLLER	36A	FINANCE AND COMPTROLLER	average	3	WASHINGTON, DC METRO AREA	-1	COLA	Not
CCE	13-2000	Financial Specialists	13-2013	Accountants and Auditors	-1	20th	Washington-Arlington-Alexandria, DC-VA-MD-WY	-1	Base Pay	Not
CCE	13-2000	Financial Specialists	13-2013	Accountants and Auditors	-1	22th	Washington-Arlington-Alexandria, DC-VA-MD-WY	-1	Base Pay	Not
CCE	13-2000	Financial Specialists	13-2013	Accountants and Auditors	-1	20th	Washington-Arlington-Alexandria, DC-VA-MD-WY	-1	Base Pay	Not
CCE	13-2000	Financial Specialists	13-2013	Budget Analysts	-1	20th	Washington-Arlington-Alexandria, DC-VA-MD-WY	-1	Base Pay	Not
CCE	13-2000	Financial Specialists	13-2013	Budget Analysts	-1	22th	Washington-Arlington-Alexandria, DC-VA-MD-WY	-1	Base Pay	Not
CCE	13-2000	Financial Specialists	13-2013	Budget Analysts	-1	20th	Washington-Arlington-Alexandria, DC-VA-MD-WY	-1	Base Pay	Not
GS	8666	ACCOUNTING AND BUDGET GROUP	8666	FINANCIAL ADMINISTRATION AND PROGRAM	-1	13	WASHINGTON-BALTIMORE-ARLINGTON, DC-MD-VA-WY-PA	-1	Base Pay	Not
GS	8666	ACCOUNTING AND BUDGET GROUP	8666	FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT	-1	13	WASHINGTON-BALTIMORE-ARLINGTON, DC-MD-VA-WY-PA	-1	Base Pay	Not
GS	8666	ACCOUNTING AND BUDGET GROUP	8618	ACCOUNTING	-1	13	WASHINGTON-BALTIMORE-ARLINGTON, DC-MD-VA-WY-PA	-1	Base Pay	Not
GS	8666	ACCOUNTING AND BUDGET GROUP	8611	AUDITING	-1	13	WASHINGTON-BALTIMORE-ARLINGTON, DC-MD-VA-WY-PA	-1	Base Pay	Not
GS	8666	ACCOUNTING AND BUDGET GROUP	8666	BUDGET ANALYSIS	-1	13	WASHINGTON-BALTIMORE-ARLINGTON, DC-MD-VA-WY-PA	-1	Base Pay	Not

Number of Depen...	Pay Type	Export
-1	Base Pay	Not

NOTES

The Notes tab provides detailed information on the Optional Step 5 pertaining to CCE. If you are not familiar with the terms and/or need assistance with making selections, then this tab will be helpful. You may also reach out to the AMCOS Help Desk (amcos@calibresys.com) should you need further assistance.

Visualization
Grade Level / Rate
Tabular / Export
Notes

Wrap Rate - A wrap rate is the estimation of all overhead added to direct labor. It encompasses things like medical benefits, paid leave, etc. and is the equivalent of 'other pay' for pay plans other than CCE. Depending on a company's cost structure this can vary but here are some data points based on the Grant Thornton survey of Government contractors (min/avg/max): Company Site (1.47/2.1/3), Client Site (1.4/1.9/2.3).

Profit (sometimes referred to as fee) is determined by companies based on their perception of the competition, their profit goals, and the risk. Their perception of risk is impacted by contract type among other things. Lower profit is typically seen in Cost Plus (CP) work (4-8%), higher profit in Fixed Price (FP) work (8-15%), and Time and Material (T&M) is generally in-between (8-12%). This reflects the Defense Acquisition University (DAU) training that FP contracts put the risk on the company (contractor), CP puts the risk on the Government, and T&M is in between. Note that these ranges are very general and for reference only. The individual circumstances of the costing exercise should dictate the profit estimate used.

Annual Hours Basis is what companies use to convert annual salary to hourly. The calculation varies but is generally 2088 (52 weeks/year * 5 work days/week * 8 hours per day).

Bid hours are how many hours the contractor bids, or the Government requires, for the position. This varies but generally for a Full Time Equivalent (FTE) an 1,880 figure is used (2088 - 10 holidays of 8 hours each which is 80 hours - 15 Personal Days or 120 hours). Other FTE hours basis include 1,920 (contracts which expect above average work) or below 1,880 if less work or more leave is expected or observed in the target industry. The Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) publishes the Employer Costs for Employee Compensation (ECC) data by occupational and industry group if this information is helpful. Note it is not in the format of total leave hours, but rather cost per hour for 'Paid leave' which can be used in an index type of way (e.g. Management, business, and financial occupations might be \$7.07/hr while Construction, extraction... workers are \$1.63/hr meaning if letting a construction contract the annual hours basis might be bid higher by the contractor).

Putting it all together: An individual is paid \$58,800 annually at say a 1.9 wrap, 10% profit, and default 1,880 hour level equates to \$94,451.92 in annual cost (\$58,800 / 2088 * 1.9 * 1.1 * 1,880).

When no selections are made in Step 4 (Costs to Sum) then the above computation is used, subject to user adjustments to Step 5 elements. The moment a user selects base pay, or any other cost group to include 'Other Pay', the data will show only CCE base pay. This unfortunately is due to a current limitation.